



PROCEDURE

Personal Duress Alarms

Scope (Staff):	All Staff
Scope (Area):	CAMHS Community and Specialised Directorates

Child Safe Organisation Statement of Commitment

CAHS commits to being a child safe organisation by applying the National Principles for Child Safe Organisations. This is a commitment to a strong culture supported by robust policies and procedures to reduce the likelihood of harm to children and young people.

Contents

Aim.....	2
Risk.....	2
Definitions	2
Key points	2
Equipment.....	3
Storage and Location.....	3
Charging	3
Procedure for Use of the SafeTCard	4
Activation of device - Red Alert	5
False Alarms.....	8
CAMHS Emergency Escalation Contacts.....	8
Responsibilities of CAMHS Emergency Escalation Contacts	9
Device failure	9
Periodic testing of devices	10
Reporting of device issues	10
Training and Education	11
Compliance monitoring	11
Appendix 1: CAMHS Nominated Emergency Escalation Contacts for Personal Duress Alarms	13
Appendix 2: CAMHS Periodic Testing of SafeTCard Quick Reference Guide	14

Aim

This procedure describes the processes associated with the use of SafeTCard Personal Duress Alarms (PDAs). It provides staff with information on the functions of PDAs, the role of the Alarm Receiving Centre (ARC), agreed periodic testing, maintenance of equipment and response management and reporting of activated SafeTCard PDAs.

Risk

- Non-compliance resulting in the ineffective use of PDAs.
- Lack of available support for an employee when in a threatening situation and a red alert is activated.

Definitions

Code Black: A coordinated response to a threat situation, which may be variously classified as 'Personal Threat', 'Self-Harm', 'Alpha' or 'Bravo'

Community Visit (CV): when an employee attends any setting that is outside of the physical location of a CAMHS facility and is not a client's personal residence to provide services.

Personal Duress Alarm (PDA): a device that, when activated, indicates that a person is under threat and requires immediate assistance. A PDA is a wireless device that is worn by a person for activation of duress alarm inside the workplace and/or while on home or community visits.

Home Visit (HV): when an employee attends a client's home to provide services.

Manager: refers to relevant authority including Line Manager/Supervisor/Coordinator.

Working Alone: an employee is considered to work alone when they:

- Are on their own;
- Cannot be seen or heard by another person; OR
- Cannot expect a visit from another worker or member of the public for some time.

SafeTCard: the brand of personal duress alarm used within CAMHS Community and Specialised Directorates.

CAMHS System Administrator: This is the nominated representative that liaises with SafeTCard. This role is responsible for duties including; Maintaining the PDA Master Asset Register; actioning PDA change requests; managing fault reporting; requesting compliance and activation report requests.

Key points

- Staff who conduct home or community visits or who work alone must use a PDA in accordance with the CAMHS Home and Community Visits procedure. Use of the PDA does not replace comprehensive risk assessment processes.
- Periodic monthly testing is required to ensure that devices remain fully operational, and that staff maintain confidence in using the devices.

- CAMHS Corporate and Business Support staff must refer to the CAMHS Personal Duress Alarm Response Management and Reporting instructions in Appendix 3

Equipment

- SafeTCard PDA
- Power cable
- Approved non-alcohol-based surface cleaning wipe (Tuffie wipes)
- Outlook calendar

Storage and Location

- The PDAs will be stored at each CAMHS site in a pre-determined location (identified by the Service Manager) with charger connected to power.
- A master PDA asset register will be managed by the CAMHS SafeTCard System Administrator.

Charging

- PDAs take 2 to 3 hours to fully charge. Alerts can be activated whilst charging.
- When removed from the charger, the SafeTCard device will automatically become 'live', and any activation will send an alarm to the Monitoring Centre.
- Use the charger cord supplied by SafeTCard.
- PDA's should be charged daily.



Procedure for Use of the SafeTCard

1. Preparation before home/community site visit

Steps	Additional Information
Turn device on: press and hold the power button on the device (<i>remember the device is already on when unplugged directly from charger</i>) 	- The device will vibrate once and one audible noise is heard. Release the power button. - Approximate 30 second start up sequence. To turn the device off: - Press and hold power button, device will vibrate once. Release button. “Power down now” will very briefly appear on screen.
Staff using PDAs are to ensure they have these key contact numbers stored in their mobile phone.	- Alarm Receiving Centre – 07 4037 4888 - CAMHS Corporate Office – 08 6389 5800 - CAMHS Site/Service Reception
Complete a status check prior to use of the SafeTCard device. Refer to the Quick Reference Guide in Appendix 2	If the SafeTCard is not working: - Notify your Service Manager immediately. The Service Manager will remove the device from circulation until the issue is resolved. - Take an alternative SafeTCard to the home or community visit. - If no other SafeTCard is available, a risk assessment is to be carried out to determine whether the visit should proceed, or if there is an alternate venue to mitigate any risk.
Ensure Home/ Community visit is booked in Outlook calendar with clients initials and full address included in the booking.	As per CAMHS Home and Community Visits procedure
Sign out the PDA using the Site Personal Duress Alarm Sign Out/In sheet	

2. Arrival and prior to entering home/community site

- Record a **Yellow Alert** voice recording prior to entering a residence or other location. This voice recording acts as a verbal GPS marker.
- If there is any concern for your welfare and the ARC is unable to determine your location using GPS signal, the ARC can access the yellow alert voice message bank to determine your location.

Steps	Additional Information
Record a Yellow Alert voice recording: Press and hold the yellow alert button until you hear one beep, release. 	- Menu option will display on screen. - Use power button to scroll down, select voice record by pressing SOS
When prompted, leave your voice recording <i>Example message "Shannon Smith at 10 Example Street Unit 3 Level 1 Citizen Town Postcode 4321. Here for a meeting."</i>	You have 20 seconds to record a message
On completion of your message, press SOS again to stop the recording.	

Activation of device – Red Alert

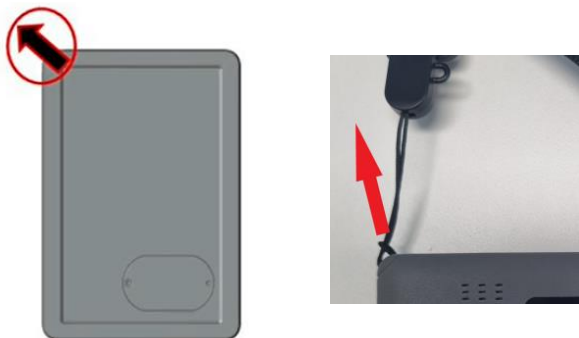
Activate a Red Alert any time you feel that your safety is at risk.

The Red Alert can be automatically activated using either of the two methods 'Red Alert (SOS) Button' or 'Red Alert Rip' Alarm activation. The Red Alert button allows for discreet alert activation.

Method 1: Red Alert Button activation

Steps	Additional Information
Red Alert activation: press and hold the SOS button (see below) until you feel 1 vibration, release. 	- SOS will display on the screen - In the event of Red Alert activation, you will feel 1 vibration every 10 seconds for the alert duration - Takes approximately 30-40 seconds to connect
The device will immediately call the ARC.	- Audio is automatically activated. The ARC can hear the user and the conversation will be recorded. - If obvious to the ARC that the user is at extreme risk, they will contact the police directly. If not, the ARC will contact the CAMHS nominated escalation contact who will ascertain the requirement for additional support.

Method 2: Red Alert Rip Alarm activation

Steps	Additional Information
Red Alert Rip Alarm activation: Pull on the lanyard to release the magnetic pin on the corner of the device where the lanyard attaches. 	- Device vibrates once. - RIP will display on screen. - The device will vibrate once every 10 seconds for duration of alert. - Takes approximately 30-40 seconds to connect.

Steps	Additional Information
Once an alarm is activated inform the attacker that the duress has been activated and WA Police will be attending. - repeating this statement to ensure the ARC responds immediately for an urgent response - if concerned that mention of impending arrival of Police may place staff at greater risk, use subtle statement to alert the ARC without drawing the attacker's attention. <i>Example message, "Code Black. Code Black".</i>	When the ARC receives an alert from a SafeTCard, the operator will: - Monitor and start recording the audio. - Assess and determine the best course of action. This may include: - Contacting the clinician if they believe it is a false alarm; OR - Dispatching emergency services as required. CAMHS Emergency escalation contacts are informed immediately after dispatch of emergency services; OR - Contacting CAMHS Emergency escalation contacts assigned to the PDA device to advise that a Red Alert has been activated.

Method 3: Incapacitation Alert activation

Steps	Additional Information
This alert is activated automatically if the device is dropped from approximately chest height. 	- Device will beep once. - MDOWN will display on screen. - The device will vibrate once every 10 seconds for the duration of the alert. - Approx. 30-40 seconds to connect.

False Alarms

Steps	Additional Information
Cancel the alarm immediately: notify the ARC by speaking into the audio microphone on the device. <i>Example message “Shannon Smith. CAMHS Community. False Alarm. Everything is okay.”</i>	Where possible, move away from the client to maintain privacy.
Deactivate the Alert: press and hold the SOS button until you feel 1 vibration, release. To deactivate a RIP alert, insert magnetic pin <i>before</i> pressing SOS button. Press and hold SOS button until you feel 1 vibration, release.	• SOS Cancelled will display briefly on screen. • Incapacitation alert – MDOWN Cancelled will display briefly on screen. • Red Alert is now cancelled.

3. After home/community site visit

Steps	Additional Information
Turn device off: press and hold the power button until you feel the device vibrate once, release	“Power down now” will appear briefly on screen.
Sign in the PDA using the Site Personal Duress Alarm Sign Out/ In sheet.	Ensure Home/ Community visit responsibilities (as outlined in CAMHS Home and Community Visiting policy) are completed.
Return device to charge: ensure the device is placed on charge and stored in a secure location.	

CAMHS Emergency Escalation Contacts

- Any Red Alert Activation will trigger a response from the ARC and contact with the CAMHS nominated emergency escalation by the ARC.
- All communication from ARC will be initiated via the reception contact number for the first or second contact/s.
- On receiving a call from the ARC, administration staff are to **immediately**

advise the Service Manager/Leadership Team member that a Red Alert has been activated.

- The CAMHS Emergency Escalation contact is the responsible officer who will assess the situation and provide direction/delegation (see Appendix 1).

In MST, the escalation contacts provided to the ARC are typically;

- First contact:** Service Manager for whichever MST team (ie. North or South)
- Second contact:** Service Manager for the other MST team (ie. North or South)
- Third contact:** Service Director, Specialised, CAMHS Executive Office

In all other parts of CAMHS, the escalation contacts provided to the ARC are typically;

- First contact:** Service Manager for Community Clinic Site/Service
- Second contact:** Service Director, Community, CAMHS Executive Office

Responsibilities of CAMHS Emergency Escalation contacts

- Provide direction and delegation in response to an activated alarm. For example;
 - Ensure that attempts are made to contact the staff member(s) by mobile. If unable to contact the staff member, liaise further with the ARC 07 4037 4888 for an update on the situation and determine if WA Police should be contacted to urgently attend the address.
 - Provide additional information to ARC as required.
- Advise CAMHS Leadership immediately of incidents that are not false alarms.
- Where relevant, follow the [Emergency affecting a CAHS Community Service or Site](#) process.
- Ensure all incidents are reported in accordance with the [CAHS Incident and Hazard Reporting Policy](#).

Device failure

- The SafeTCard will only work in areas with mobile network coverage. If the user enters an area without mobile network coverage, the SafeTCard ID does not alert the user. However, if the user attempts to activate an alert in an area with no mobile coverage the SafeTCard will vibrate once and a red light will appear briefly in the display screen.
- In the event of device failure during a home or community visit, the

clinician must continue to follow normal risk assessment practices. If the clinician determines that a situation has become unsafe, they should;

- Attempt to use their mobile phone to contact emergency services; and
- Remove themselves from the situation if possible.

Periodic testing of devices

- It is a requirement of [CAHS Duress Alarm Policy](#) that duress alarm testing is regularly undertaken.
- All CAMHS SafeTCard devices must be tested **monthly**.
- A Service Manager must either complete the periodic testing form for each device themselves or nominate a staff member to complete it on their behalf. Regular drills to maintain confidence and understanding in the use of the devices are recommended for any staff using PDAs.
- Refer to CAMHS Periodic Testing Quick Reference Guide for instructions on how to complete a test (Appendix 2).
- [SafeTCard Periodic Testing Forms](#) are to be submitted monthly to the CAMHS System Administrator.

Reporting of device issues

- Any operating problems/ issues with devices are to be reported to the System Administrator.
- Service Managers are to remove faulty devices from circulation immediately.
- Any device that is lost or stolen is to be reported to the CAMHS SafeTCard Systems Administrator immediately so that the SIM card can be disabled. The ARC should also be notified immediately in the event of theft/loss.
- In the event of theft or loss, it is the Service Manager's responsibility to lodge an insurance claim as per the [Insurance Claim Process – Risk Cover procedure](#).

Training and Education

- CAMHS Core requirement for all administration and clinical staff (excluding Acute services).
- Completion of a PDA education package is required prior to use of a device. This relates to any staff involved in testing or responding to an activated alarm.
- Site orientation checklists will ensure that staff are familiar with the location and charging station for PDA devices.

Compliance monitoring

- The CAMHS System Administrator is required to extract monthly reports from SafeTCard. The reports must include:
 - Percentage of duress alarms tested and reported (Target 100%)
 - Percentage of response to duress alarms (Target 100%)
- The CAMHS System Administrator must submit the monthly reports to the CAMHS Safety and Quality team for reporting to CAMHS Executive Governance Committee.
- Reports are subsequently provided to CAHS Emergency Management Committee.

Related CAHS internal policies, procedures and guidelines

[CAMHS Home and Community Visits procedure](#)

[Emergency affecting a CAHS Community Service or Site](#)

[CAHS Incident and Hazard Reporting Policy](#)

[CAHS Duress Alarm Policy](#)

[SafeTCard Periodic Testing Forms](#)

[Insurance Claim Process – Risk Cover procedure](#)

References and related external legislation, policies, and guidelines

[WA Work Health and Safety Act 2020](#)

[Department of Health Community Mental Health Status Assessments: Role of Mental Health Clinicians Policy \(MP 0099/18\)](#)

Useful resources (including related forms) *(if required)*

[CAMHS Emergency Management: Procedures and Action Cards](#)

[CAMHS SafeTCard Periodic Testing completion form](#)

This document can be made available in alternative formats on request.

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 Healthy kids, healthy communities CompassionExcellenceCollaborationAccountabilityEquityRespect Neonatology Community Health Mental Health Perth Children's Hospital			

Appendix 1: CAMHS Nominated Emergency Escalation Contacts for Personal Duress Alarms

Service	Responsible Officer Contact 1	Responsible Officer Contact 2	Responsible Officer Contact 3
Acute CAMHS (CCC)	Manager, CAMHS Crisis Connect	Director, Acute CAMHS Executive Office	N/A
Armada Community CAMHS	Service Manager Armada Community CAMHS	Director, Community CAMHS Executive Office	N/A
Bentley Community CAMHS	Service Manager Bentley Community CAMHS	Director, Community CAMHS Executive Office	N/A
Clarkson Community CAMHS	Service Manager Clarkson Community CAMHS	Director, Community CAMHS Executive Office	N/A
Fremantle Community CAMHS	Service Manager Fremantle Community CAMHS	Director, Community CAMHS Executive Office	N/A
Hillarys Community CAMHS	Service Manager Hillarys Community CAMHS	Director, Community CAMHS Executive Office	N/A
Peel Community CAMHS	Service Manager Peel Community CAMHS	Director, Community CAMHS Executive Office	N/A
Rockingham Community CAMHS	Service Manager Rockingham Community CAMHS	Director, Community CAMHS Executive Office	N/A
Shenton Community CAMHS	Service Manager Shenton Community CAMHS	Director, Community CAMHS Executive Office	N/A
Swan Community CAMHS	Service Manager Swan Community CAMHS	Director, Community CAMHS Executive Office	N/A
Warwick Community CAMHS	Service Manager Warwick Community CAMHS	Director, Community CAMHS Executive Office	N/A
CAHDS Specialised CAMHS	Service Manager CAHDS CAMHS	Director, Specialised Services CAMHS Executive Office	N/A
Multi Systemic Therapy (MST) – North Specialised CAMHS	Service Manager MST North CAMHS	Service Manager MST South CAMHS	Director, Specialised Services CAMHS Executive Office
Multi Systemic Therapy (MST) – South Specialised CAMHS	Service Manager MST South CAMHS	Service Manager MST North CAMHS	Director, Specialised Services CAMHS Executive Office
Pathways Specialised CAMHS	Service Manager Pathways CAMHS	Director, Specialised Services CAMHS Executive Office	N/A
Touchstone Specialised CAMHS	Service Manager Touchstone CAMHS	Director, Specialised Services CAMHS Executive Office	N/A

Appendix 2: CAMHS Periodic Testing of SafeTCard Quick Reference Guide

The SafeTCard(s) are to be tested monthly with the Alarm Receiving Centre (ARC). Instructions for testing with the ARC are also located next to the SafeTCards.

Steps	Additional Information
CAHS CAMHS to phone ARC to advise that a test is about to be performed	ARC contact: 07 4037 4888 and follow the prompts to speak directly to an operator.
Inform the operator that you are testing the device and provide the serial number. The ARC operator will put the device on the test account. When confirmed, end the call and proceed with testing.	- The serial number is located under the CAHS CAMHS ID card. - Slide the ID Card out to view the serial number located in the bottom right hand corner. - The TAG No: E00XXXXXX located on the back can also be used to identify the device. - While in "Test Mode", the ARC will not call Emergency Nominated Escalation contacts.
Activate the Alert by; - pressing the Red Alert (SOS) button on the rear of the SafeTCard device until one vibration is felt; OR - Pulling the lanyard rip	- SOS will display on the screen. - The PDA device will open a one-way audio call to the ARC. 1 vibration will be felt every 10 seconds for alert duration to confirm that the oneway audio link is open.
Upon opening of the audio link the person performing the test to announce the following: CODE BLACK TEST, CODE BLACK TEST, CODE BLACK TEST	Takes approximately 30-40 seconds to connect
Close the alert on the device by pressing and holding the Red Alert (SOS) button on the rear of the device until one vibration is felt, release.	- SOS Cancelled will display briefly on screen - If tested with Rip alarm, reinsert the magnetic pin first.
Call the ARC again and inform the operator that you have completed testing and closed the alert. The operators will provide any relevant feedback.	ARC will return the ID card to "Live State"
Record the outcome of the test by submitting the online SafeTCard Periodic Testing Forms.	**If test is for education purposes you do not need to record the outcome.